MOUNTAIN REVIEW

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION NEWSLETTER

Volume IV Issue III Summer 2014

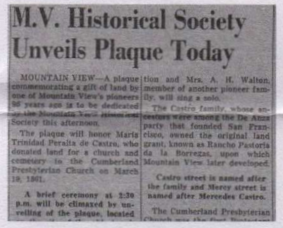
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See what the MVHA was up to in Spring 2014!
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60 Year Scrapbook



M.V. Historical Society Unveils Plaque Today

MOUNTAIN VIEW—A plaque commemorating a gift of land by one of Mountain View's pioneers 50 years ago is to be dedicated ... Society this afternoon.

The plaque will honor Marta Trinidad Peralta de Castro, who donated land for a church and cemetery to the Cumberland Presbyterian Church on March 18, 1861.

A brief ceremony at 2:30 p.m. will be climaxed by unveiling of the plaque, located ... tion and Mrs. A. H. Walton, member of another pioneer family, will sing a solo.

The Castro family, whose ancestors were among the De Anza party that founded San Francisco, owned the original land grant, known as Rancho Pastoria de la Borregas, upon which Mountain View later developed.

Castro street is named after the family and Mercy street is named after Mercedes Castro.

The Cumberland Presbyterian ...

As we celebrate our 60th anniversary, take a look back at the early years of the MVHA
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Summer BBQ!



Get the details on our annual Summer social gathering - and this year - our 60th anniversary party!
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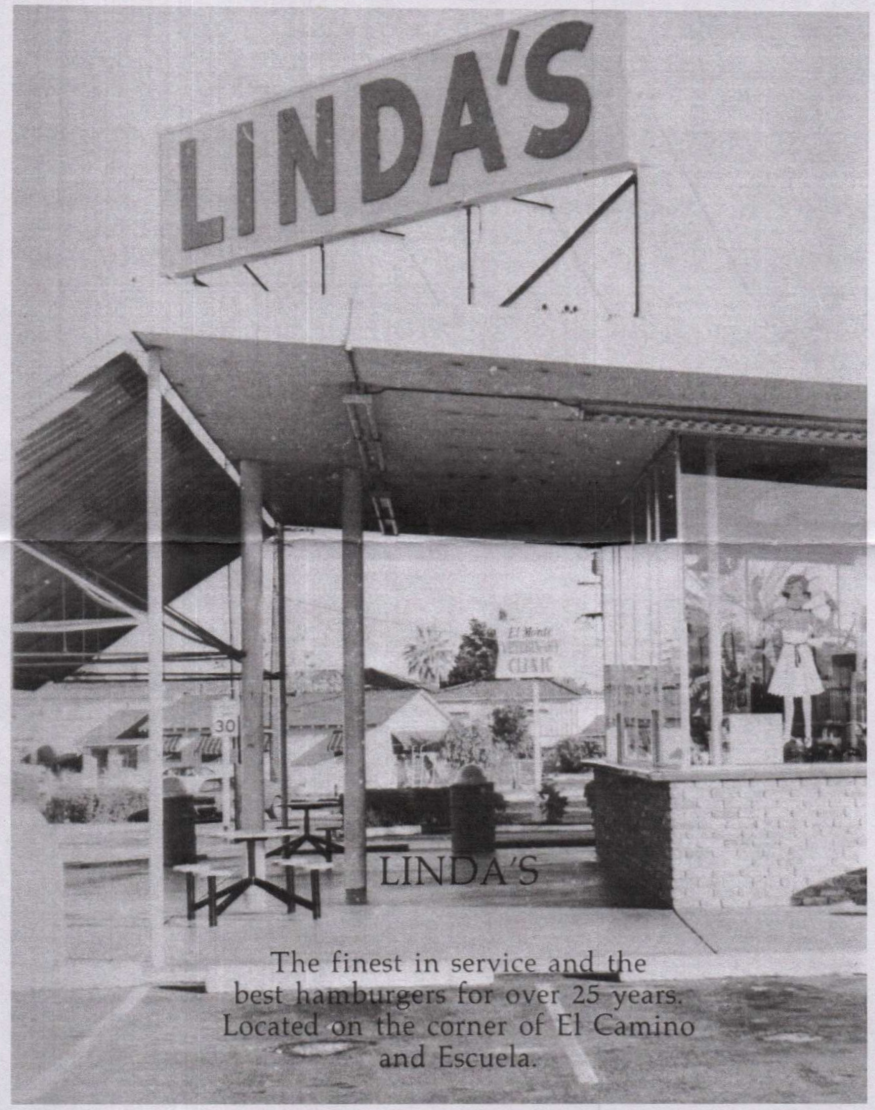
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1980 Mtn. View High School Yearbook Advertisement for Linda's Drive-In

Nearly three decades after its closure (!) Linda's Drive-In remains a Mountain View legend. The iconic burger stand opened in 1956 on the north-east corner of El Camino Real and Escuela Avenue. Owners Dean and Rebecca Riggs named the drive-in after their daughter, Linda. Ever since its closure in 1985, fans have strived to recreate Linda's famous Parisian Burger with its "secret" sauce.

As a special treat for our 60th Anniversary BBQ we'll be serving our version of this classic Mountain View dish. We hope you'll join us at the BBQ to try it out! If the response is good - we'll make this an annual tradition. **Linda herself might also join us with her family!** RSVP/Ticket Order form is available on page 7 if you did not already receive one in the mail. Hope to see you there!

1954-2014
60
MOUNTAIN REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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Hospitality: Helene Hughes
Memorial & Remembrances: Vacant
Programs: Bob Weaver

Hop on Board!

Help chart the future of our historical association! Board and Chair positions are open and we will be electing a new board in Fall.

For more information contact:
Patricia Figueroa
patfig@ix.netcom.com

News & Notes

President's Message

By Patricia Figueroa
MVHA President

Hi Everyone,

It is time for our annual BBQ and as you see this year we are having the theme of "Linda's Burgers." Who can resist an authentic "Parisian Burger"? We have even special ordered the correct type of buns and Linda herself (who may be joining us!) is providing the recipe for the "special sauce." And yes, there will also be some "special fries." The BBQ will be a piece of history for the taste buds.

It seems right to bring a little piece Mid-Century Mountain View history to our annual BBQ as we celebrate the 60th of the Mountain View Historical Association. In 1954 this community recognized the need to preserve "yesterday" for "today". I'd like to take this opportunity to say "Thank You" to all the Board Members past and present for the time and effort you have given to this organization.

A very special "farewell" to Barbara Kinchen, our Historical Data Chair, who is retiring from weekly volunteer hours at the History Center in the Mountain View Public Library. Barbara is a longtime MVHA volunteer and has served as official City Historian since 1994. Barbara, you will be missed!

Hope to see everyone at our BBQ on August 3rd!

.

Some heartfelt words of thanks were posted on to our facebook page in honor of the retirement of Bobbie Kinchen and Betty Engberg from the History Room:



"Thank you both for making our local history interesting and accessible. It was a pleasure visiting you on Tuesday afternoons, and getting expert answers to my many questions."
-Doug Johnson

"Thanks for the help gave and helping me find out my great aunt worked for the 1930 census in MV!"
-Mark Peterson

"All the Best for you!!!
I will miss seeing you girls at 'The Pioneer Room'"
-Larry Leib

"Thank you both for the amazing tales of Mountain View and the area around it, plus your incredible life journeys that you shared with me while I tried to help in the library. You two are my inspiration and I always feel so lucky to have you known while I lived in the area."
-Christine Shaw *("the English one!")*

New to the History Center

By Barbara Kinchen
Historical Data Chair

From Alex Brown: 1950 aerial map including Mountain View area between railroad tracks, Stierlin Road, Highway 101 and Mountain View-Alviso Road.

Unknown Donor: Plastic coffee cups advertising "Trailer Supplies, 1128 El Camino Real, Mountain View."
A United California Bank cloth deposit bag.
Workman's tool apron stamped Bickell Bros. Lumber.

Editor's Note: *As part of her retirement from the History Center, Barbara Kinchen will no longer be providing the* ***Mtn. ReView*** *with frequent "New to the History Center" and "Street Talk" columns. If anyone would like to help keep these columns going, please contact us:* ***mvha.newsletter@gmail.com***

Financial Report

By John Figueroa
Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 3/12/14: $ 6,931.85
- Income: $387.04
- Expenses: $1,472.59

Checking Account Balance as of 3/12/14: $ 5,846.30

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 3/12/14: $83,006.11
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 6/11/14: $83,017.71

Membership Report

By June Casey
Membership Chair

Membership as of June 11, 2014

Honored Members	2
Life Members	116
Family Members	66
Single Members	112
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**296**

New Members:
Larry Leib

Thank you to all our members, new and old! If you'd like to renew our join the organization - a membership application is available on Page 7!

The History Center

The Mountain View History Center's mission is to collect, organize and make available Mountain View historical resources and to promote the city's heritage. It contains the historic archives of both the Mountain View Historical Association and the Mountain View Public Library. Historical books and pamphlets on the history of Mountain View are also available for purchase at the History Center.

Location:
Mountain View Public Library, 2nd Floor
585 Franklin Street
Mountain View, CA 94041

Hours:
The history center is open to the general public from 1-5pm every Tuesday and by appointment.

Call 650-903-6890 for more information.

Call for Submissions

The ***Mtn. ReView*** welcomes submissions! Deadline for our Fall 2014 newsletter is Oct. 14, Articles, photos, letters to the editor, and any other ideas can be e-mailed to:

mvha.newsletter@gmail.com.

Mail them to the ***Mtn. ReView*** at:
298 Pettis Avenue, Mtn.View CA 94041

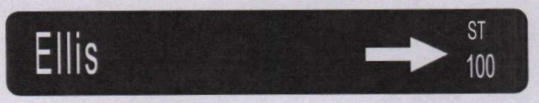
Join us today!

The Mtn.View Historical Association welcomes new members! Any person who signifies interest in the aims of the Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member.

The aims of the MVHA are:

- To gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View.
- To collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area
- To preserve historic objects and places
- To cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership

Street Talk



By Barbara Kinchen
Historical Data Chair



Circa 1970 Bird's Eye View of Ellis Street (MVPL Collection)

Someone researching street names within Moffett Field asked for information about Ellis Street. It extends from Highway 101 (Bayshore Highway), south to Middlefield Road, and north, under 101 to Moffett's South Gate. Early 1950s maps show it as only a very short street from Bayshore into vacant fields.

I did know of one family which favored the name Ellis, but not of any connection with the Bayshore area. Anderson Housemovers was established in Mountain View in the 1920s by Ellis Anderson, Senior. One son was Ellis, Junior. Another was Lawrence Ellis Anderson, a 1927 graduate of Mountain View Union High School and Councilmember, elected in 1954 and mayor in 1956 through 1958.

Richard Anderson, grandson of Ellis, Senior, verified that indeed the street name was of their family. Tony Janovich supplied information about the location. In 1948 Tony started work at Anderson Housemovers which was then located at Bayshore and Ellis Street. Mr. and Mrs. Ellis Anderson, Sr. lived on the property and there was enough land for all of their equipment and space to temporarily store at least five houses.

By the early 1960s, Middlefield Road had been extended east to Mountain View-Alviso Road (Highway 237) and the Industrial Land Corporation was developing over 130 acres between Bayshore, Middlefield, Whisman Road, and Highway 237 for new businesses. The Anderson brothers, Lawrence and Albert, moved their housemoving and contracting operations to Crittenden Lane in the North Bayshore Area.

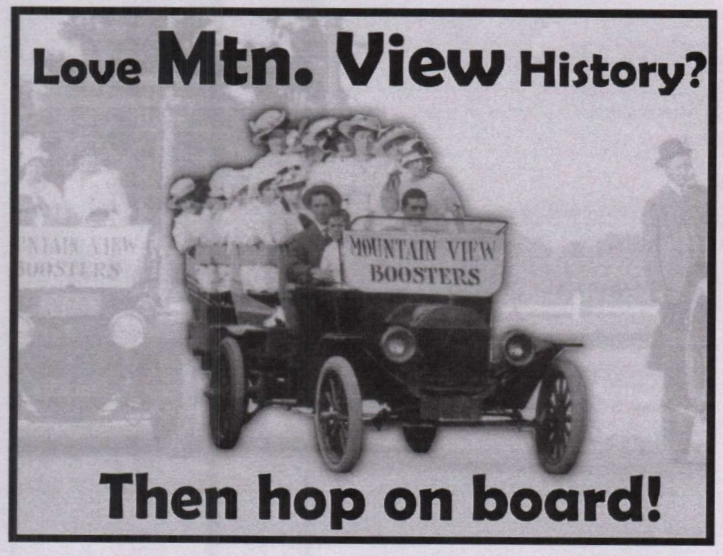
Get Involved!

The MVHA is looking for local members who want to help us share Mountain View's history with the community! Roles we are currently looking to fill are described below:

Mtn. View History Center Volunteers: With the recent retirement of Bobbie Kinchen and Betty Engberg, the MVHA is in immediate need of volunteers who can help maintain our archives and interact with the public at the Mountain View History Center on the second floor of the library.

Event Volunteers: Help staff MVHA's table at upcoming public events such as the Art & Wine Festival and Thursday Night Live. A great activity for first-time volunteers and a fun way to meet people interested in local history!

Board Members: Join us as we plan the future of the MVHA! 2015 will be a pivotal year for the organization and we welcome new board members eager to help us fulfill our mission.



If you're interested in these or any other volunteer opportunities please e-mail us at mvha.newsletter@gmail.com

Or call MVHA President Pat Figueroa at 650-965-4783

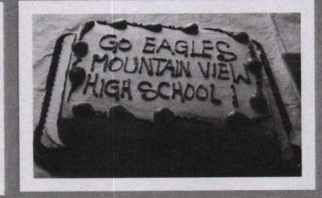
Spring Snapshots



A Tribute to Mtn. View High

Our Spring 2014 public event and meeting - A Tribute to Mtn. View High - was a great success! A multi-generational crowd gathered at the historic Adobe Building including current MVHS students and alumni from pretty much every decade stretching back to the 1930s!



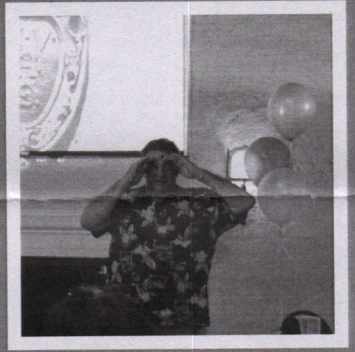


MVHS History Display (left) and a "GO EAGLES" cake



The Stars of the Show! The MVHS Madrigals wowed us with their performance!





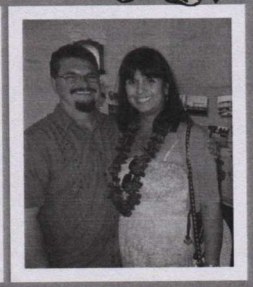
Nick Perry (left) gave a lecture on the history of all three MVHS campuses and Larry Leib (right) introduced his award winning-film "The MVHS Story." Larry will be selling DVD copies of the film at the BBQ.











A multi-generational gathering of Eagles and Spartans!



Thank You Bobbie & Betty!

On June 24 the Mtn. View Public Library honored Barbara (Bobbie) McPheeters Kinchen and Elizabeth (Betty) McPheeters Engberg for their service to the city as volunteers for the Mountain View Historical Association and the library. Bobbie, who also serves as our City Historian, has volunteered at the History Center since the 1970s! June 24 marked their last afternoon as official volunteers. We salute and thank them for their service!



MVHA Board members, library staff, friends and family all gathered at the library to celebrate both sisters' contributions as volunteers.

60 Year Scrapbook

The Mountain View Historical Association was founded on September 9, 1954 by a small group of long-time residents interested in preserving and sharing Mountain View's history. As we celebrate our 60th Anniversary, here's a selection of images that offer a glimpse of our organization's 60-year history.



A rainy dedication ceremony for the MVHA's first historic marker at the site of the Mountain View Cemetery (now Pioneer park). March 3, 1957.

M.V. Historical Society Unveils Plaque Today

MOUNTAIN VIEW—A plaque commemorating a gift of land by one of Mountain View's pioneers 96 years ago is to be dedicated by the Mountain View Historical Society this afternoon.

The plaque will honor Maria Trinidad Peralta de Castro, who donated land for a church and cemetery to the Cumberland Presbyterian Church on March 19, 1861.

A brief ceremony at 2:30 p.m. will be climaxed by unveiling of the plaque, located on the site of the old church near the present Presbyterian Church on Castro street, according to Clarence G. Taylor, president of the Society.

tion and Mrs. A. H. Walton, member of another pioneer family, will sing a solo.

The Castro family, whose ancestors were among the De Anza party that founded San Francisco, owned the original land grant, known as Rancho Pastoria da la Borregas, upon which Mountain View later developed.

Castro street is named after the family and Mercy street is named after Mercedes Castro.

The Cumberland Presbyterian Church was the first Protestant church in the Santa Clara Valley. It was founded by a group headed by Edward Dale, whose descendants are expected to attend the dedication.

1957 newspaper article on the MVHA



Dedication of the Wild Cherry Tree. marker Grant Road and Cuesta Drive, September 28, 1957. Near marker on left is Mayor Lawrence Anderson.



Dedication of Castro Adobe Site, May 3, 1959. Rev. Fr. James Doyle and Miss Mercedes Castro, last heir of the Castro family living in Mountain View.

Oldtimers Fight To Keep Quiet Charm of M.V.

MOUNTAIN VIEW—An organization fighting to keep alive memories of this bustling city's quiet past appealed for help this week.

Mountain View Pioneer and Historical Society will hold its annual meeting Sunday at 2 p.m. at the city recreational department, called The Adobe, 157 N. Moffett Blvd.

Persons interested in joining the group are invited.

Rapid growth of apartments, housing tracts, shopping centers, and industry in Mountain View threatens to wipe out any sign of the area's colorful history, Mrs. Eleanor Dale, the group's president, has warned.

Mrs. Dale said her organization has launched a membership drive to gain new recruits for the cause of research, marking, and, in some cases, preservation of sites and structures.

At the annual meeting two persons with links to early history will speak:

—Mrs. Anna Jagels Leu, daughter of George D. Jagels who in 1880 conducted a shipping business at the end of Whisman road, will review her father's part in early day business development.

—Lester Morrison, great-grandson of Andrew Davidson Firebaugh, will give a resume of experiences of his ancestors.

Firebaugh first entered California in the late 1840s with Stevenson's regiment during the Mexican War.

Morrison will also talk about the Almaden Mines.

Mrs. Dale's organization was organized in 1954 and meets four times a year.

It has placed three markers: One in Memorial Park honoring the Castro family; one at Cuesta drive and Grant road for a wild cherry tree on the pioneer Bubb Ranch used as a witness tree for surveying property; and a third near the original adobe home of the Castros located on Rengstorff avenue near Alma street.

The group also did research for Mountain View Elementary School District in naming schools for Marjane Castro, Issac Newton Graham, Frank L. Huff, and Miss Victorine Klein.

"Accurate historical data" on banks, churches, street names, ranches and other parts of community life is stored in the organization's files.

1962 article about the MVHA.



Author Cora Older (Mrs. Fremont Older). MVHA Meeting Feb 7, 1960

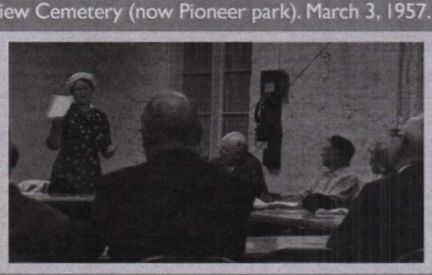
Eleanor Dale heads Mt. View historical group

Mrs. Eleanor Dale, descendant of a pioneer Mountain View family, this week was elected president of the Mountain View Pioneer and Historical Association.

Mrs. Dale succeeds Clarence Taylor, who has served three years. Other new association officers are:

Merrill S. Hugo, vice president; Mrs. Marie Hugo, secretary; and Martha Kendall, treasurer.

The association unveiled its first historical marker to be placed in the city Sunday at the cemetery of Cumberland Presbyterian Church, 1546 Castro St. It was the first Protestant church established on the Peninsula.



MVHA founding member and early president, Mrs. Eleanor Dale, speaks at an early meeting at the Adobe Building.



Dedication of Old Mtn. View Marker Feb 3, 1980 . L to R: Merrill Hugo, Arline Slater, Mildred Winters, Joseph Sweeney (Secretary) Barbara Kinchen (Treasurer) Ray Kendall (V. President,) Jeanne Holtzclaw, DeWitt Hogle, (President).



Phil Galvan, an Ohlone Indian descendent, speaks at 1972 MVHA meeting.



"A Sense of Mountain View" Rengstorff Recreation Center. May 14, 1983. Helen Madsen. Mildred Winters. Ben DeBolt.



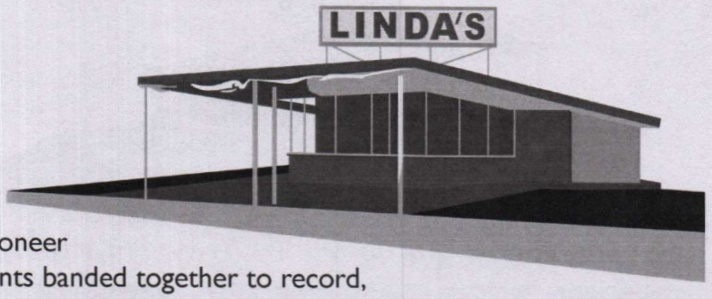
MVHA Save the Adobe campaign brochure from the 1990s.



1988 MVHA Board - Front Row. Mary Lentz, Honor Spitz, Norene Hogle. Back Row. Barbara Kinchen, Roberta Bubb Sweeney, Alice Holden, DeWitt Hogle, George Holden.

Summer Event Preview

Summer Barbeque & 60th Anniversary Party!



In the 1950s, Mountain View experienced an unprecedented growth boom. The surrounding countryside quickly gave way to new neighborhoods, shopping centers, and campuses for companies that would later earn the "Valley of Heart's Delight" a new nickname, the "Silicon Valley."

This was the historical context in which the Mountain View Pioneer and Historical Association emerged. In 1954, a group of residents banded together to record, preserve, and celebrate Mountain View's history. As rapid growth dramatically changed Mountain View, these "Pioneers" helped ensure that its rich and unique history was not forgotten. 60 years have passed since our city's Historical Association formed - much has changed, and much has been accomplished. As Mountain View experiences its latest wave of growth, the MVHA remains committed to preserving our city's unique history and sharing it with the world.

We hope you'll join us as we celebrate this milestone at our annual Summer BBQ at the historic Adobe Building on Sunday, August 3. At this year's BBQ, we're rolling back the clock to our organization's earliest years and celebrating some of the places, music, and food that made Mid-Century Mountain View such a special place - including our version of the famous "Parisian Burger" from Linda's Drive In! All members should have received a mailed invitation/RSVP form. Only limited tickets will be available at the door, so please RSVP in advance. **We hope to see you at the BBQ!**

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Membership Application & Renewal Form

+ BBQ Ticket Order Form!

RSVP DEADLINE - JULY 26

\#

BBQ Ticket - MVHA Member *($8)* _____

BBQ Ticket - Guests/Non-Member *($10)* _____

Apply for MVHA membership today & save on BBQ tickets!

BBQ Ticket - Child *($5)* _____

☐ New membership

☐ Renewal

☐ REGULAR MEMBER: *$15/year*

☐ FAMILY MEMBER: *$25/year*

☐ LIFE TIME MEMBER: *$200*

☐ *Contact me for Volunteer opportunities*

☐ *I prefer to receive the MVHA newsletter via e-mail.*

NAME(S): _____

_____

ADDRESS: _____

CITY: _____

STATE: _____ ZIP: _____

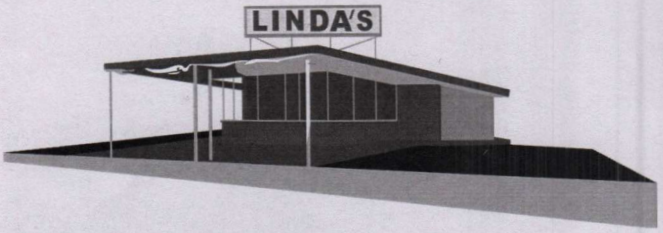
TELEPHONE: _____

E-MAIL: _____

Please make checks payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association

Mail to:
Mountain View Historical Association
PO Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

Summer/Fall 2014 Events



Summer Barbeque & 60th Anniversary Party!
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

SUMMER 2014 MVHA EVENT AND MEMBERSHIP MEETING

Sunday, August 3, 2014 at 1PM

Adobe Building - 157 Moffett Blvd.

See Page 7 for Details!

July 27 and/or August 7
Thursday Night Live! Summer Street Party
Castro Street between California and Evelyn

September 6-7
Mountain View Art & Wine Festival

Volunteers make a difference!
Please contact us if you are able to help represent the MVHA at these events.
E-mail: mvha.newsletter@gmail.com

September 10, 2014
MVHA Board Meeting
Fire Station #4, 6pm
Interested Members encouraged to attend! Board positions available.

October 4, 2014
Mtn. View Union High School Eagle Alumni Picnic
Location and Time TBA - Check website for updates

1954-2014
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Mountain View, CA 94042
WEB: www.mountainviewhistorical.org
E-MAIL: mvha.newsletter@gmail.com

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